



workshop

An inductor for the CPU. Each of these represent a single phase of power. Typically most boards have four phase power supplies

CPU Socket - This little socket is where your CPU resides. The one in the picture is an Intel LGA 1366 socket. LGA sockets mean the motherboard has the pins, while the CPU is pin-less

RAM Slots - Your memory is plugged in here. Each slot supports anywhere between two and four GB of RAM. Most boards have four slots X58 boards such as this one have six slots

Note the large heatsink cum heatpipe solution. The heatpipes whisk heat away from hot zones and the CPU fan helps dissipate this heat via the heatsinks

Optical out for digital audio connectivity

The coaxial connect also called S/PDIF for digital connectivity

USB ports - the more the merrier

SATA ports - the interface for most hard drives and the newer breed of optical drives, the more the better

LAN Port(s) - for wired network connectivity. The standard is known as RJ45

Audio Ports - for output to multi-channel speakers or headphones. These jacks are typically colour coded - green for the front channels, black for the rear channels, orange for the centre and woofer and grey for the side channels.

PCIe x1 slot - this is simply a PCIe slot with 1/16th the bandwidth of an x16 slot. The latest soundcards are built around this interface

Chips - these embedded chips correspond to the LAN ports and audio ports. The audio chip for example is an integrated circuit designed to produce sound.

The power button and reset button. Such buttons enable easy running of an open system, since pins need not be shorted for these functions

